Cells, rows and formulas

Data engineering · Level 2 · Lesson 1



In this lesson you will

- Find your way round a spreadsheet: cells and ranges.
- Use SUM, AVERAGE and COUNTIF.
- Work out a total and an average in Python.

Key ideas

- Every cell has an address, like B2.
- Formulas start with = and update by themselves.
- sum and len do the same job in Python.

Formulas by hand

1. Grid (3 min): letters and numbers
2. Address (3 min): find the cells
3. Formula (5 min): SUM and AVERAGE
4. Change (4 min): one mark changes

Use made-up marks. If you have a spreadsheet app, try the same formulas on it.

Let’s discuss

1. What does the colon in B2:B9 mean?
2. Why does a formula beat a calculator?
3. Why can’t SUM add “14 / 17”?

Exit ticket

- Write a formula for the average of cells C2 to C10.